

LESSONS OF PRAISE FROM JERICHO

(The Power Of Rejoicing)

Joshua 6:1-5 (NKJV) *“Now Jericho was securely shut up because of the children of Israel; none went out, and none came in. ² And the LORD said to Joshua: “See! I have given Jericho into your hand, its king, and the mighty men of valor. ³ You shall march around the city, all you men of war; you shall go all around the city once. This you shall do six days. ⁴ And seven priests shall bear seven trumpets of rams’ horns before the ark. But the seventh day you shall march around the city seven times, and the priests shall blow the trumpets. ⁵ It shall come to pass, when they make a long blast with the ram’s horn, and when you hear the sound of the trumpet, that all the people shall shout with a great shout; then the wall of the city will fall down flat. And*

the people shall go up every man straight before him.”

- Joshua – New leader... The Jordan was his first real test... When they had successfully crossed Jordan the Word say's ***“They respected Joshua as they had respected Moses.”*** (If you will pray and seek the face of God and operate in a prophetic anointing, some people will be afraid to mess with you!)
- Jericho was Joshua's second test... It was a strong and fortified city. Jericho was going to be confronted by nomads at the best! (Story of drunk pushing a freight train)

What was the battle plan? Make 13 trips around the city without saying a word! You gotta be kidding me! (Pentecostals are not good at quiet)

The Israelites had spent the last forty years

talking themselves out of the Promised Land! (They squeezed an 11 day trip into 40 years) If God was ever going to get them into the Promised Land He would have to shut them up for seven days! (My experience at a spiritual retreat – Couldn't say a word for 12 hours – I almost died! I heard more from God in that 12 hours than I had heard from the previous 12 months)

If you came to this conference looking for a word – I will one up you – I have two words for you SHUT UP!

- SHUT UP about your board...
- SHUT UP about your carnal church members...
- SHUT UP about your finances...
- SHUT UP about your wife - you married her...
- SHUT UP about your children who are on a one-way-trip to Stupidville...

Your conversation is killing your faith! God

could get a victory to some of us if He could get us to shut up long enough to build our faith!

The walking, marching and the praising was going to have to happen before any results...

The Battle of Jericho teaches us that sometimes we have to:

- Walk when it doesn't make any sense...
- Walk when it seems that we are going in circles... (You gotta keep walking...)
- Walk when the enemy stands over us mocking... (The guards on the walls of Jericho were no doubt mocking before trip 13 was complete)
- Walk when our rational minds say, this is no way to win a war...
- Walk when it is the last thing on earth we feel like doing...

After thirteen trips around the wall, the quiet game ended and it was time to shout! At one

critical moment:

- The marching would stop... (There will be a time when God will bring your issue to a head – You gotta let it be God’s timing not yours – Situation with deacon at Fouke - Stand still and see the salvation of the Lord – Someone is about to make their last trip around the wall)
- The music will begin... (The priests were to blow the trumpet)
- You will have to shout by faith – (They were told to shout when it made no logical sense to do so)

In Acts 16 Paul and Silas had been beaten, thrown into jail and sternly warned not to preach in this name again. Listen to what the Bible say’s, ***“About midnight Paul & Silas were praying and singing praises to God ... suddenly... there was such a violent earthquake, that the foundations of the prison were shaken. At once all the prison doors flew open & everybody’s chains came***

loose.”

There's something about your praise He loves! Send up a **SHOUT** of praise today and God will start tapping His foot for you!

You would be surprised how many of your walls would fall down flat if you would praise Him!

God is attracted to praise – (Music practice for this conference drew a crowd)

Anytime you **PRAISE** God in spite of your circumstances, the forces of heaven come to your assistance.

You say, “*But I don’t feel like praising God.*” Then listen, SHUT UP until you can “*...offer to God a sacrifice of praise*” (Hebrews 13:15).

Anybody can praise Him in the good times,

but when you **RISE ABOVE** your feelings and to do it—that's when it's most effective! If you can praise Him when you are wading in alligator infested water up to your armpits, you can rest assured your praise will confuse the devil and God **WILL** come through for you!

The same power that opened every prison door for Paul and Silas broke down the walls of Jericho! ***“The walls fell down flat.”***
(Illustrate a guard on the wall when the walls started shaking)

The power of praise still:

- Opens prison doors...
- Shuts the mouths of hungry lions...
- Takes the heat out of the fire...
- Neutralizes the venom of poisonous snakes...
- Breaks down walls of resistance...

CONCLUSION:

(Have the people to walk around building in silence – Afterwards have musicians to start playing loudly and the people to shout as loud as they can)